

MOHAMMED ALEEMUDDIN

ABHAY DANG, *36*
Software Development Manager at an MNC (left)

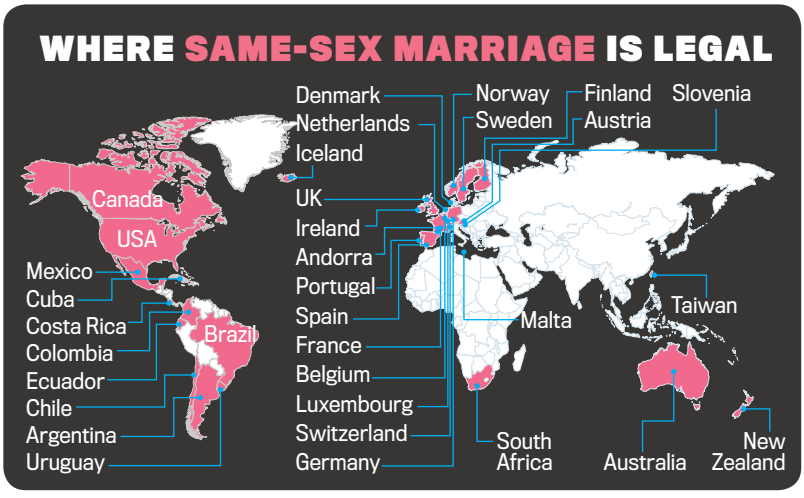
SUPRIYO CHAKRABORTY, *33*
Event manager and wedding planner

While Abhay is from Delhi, Supriyo hails from Ashok Nagar, a small town near Kolkata. They now live together in Hyderabad

'WE'RE STRANGERS IN THE EYES OF LAW'

financial investments. There is no legal provision for them to inherit each other's assets. "If any two people want to share their lives, will their property to someone of their sexual or any other choice, why should it interest the rest of the family members? How that person is legally recognised is a mere technicality that our learned courts can iron out rather than forcing citizens of a progressive nation to live in sheer hypocrisy," says Aman Nath, writer, hotelier and architectural restorer. He was one of the litigants in the 2018 case that decriminalised same-sex relationships between consenting adults. Same-sex marriages are recognised in 34 countries of the world now (*see accompanying graphic*).

One of the major rights that same-sex couples are demanding is the one to adopt children and bring them up as part of a family. Current rules allow one partner to adopt a child as a single parent but do not allow the other partner to have any legal right over the child. Last year, the government curtailed even that right when in an office memorandum on June 16, 2022, the Central Adoption Resource Authority (CARA) laid down that a single prospective adoptive parent who is in a live-in relationship with a partner will not be considered eligible to adopt a child. The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights has also opposed adoption by same-sex couples, saying in a submission to the apex court that "allowing adoption to same-sex couples



In 2000, the Netherlands became the first country to legalise same-sex marriage. In Asia, Taiwan was the first country to recognise such unions in 2019

Out of the 34 countries in the world that recognise same-sex marriage, 10 have done so via court rulings, and the rest through legislation